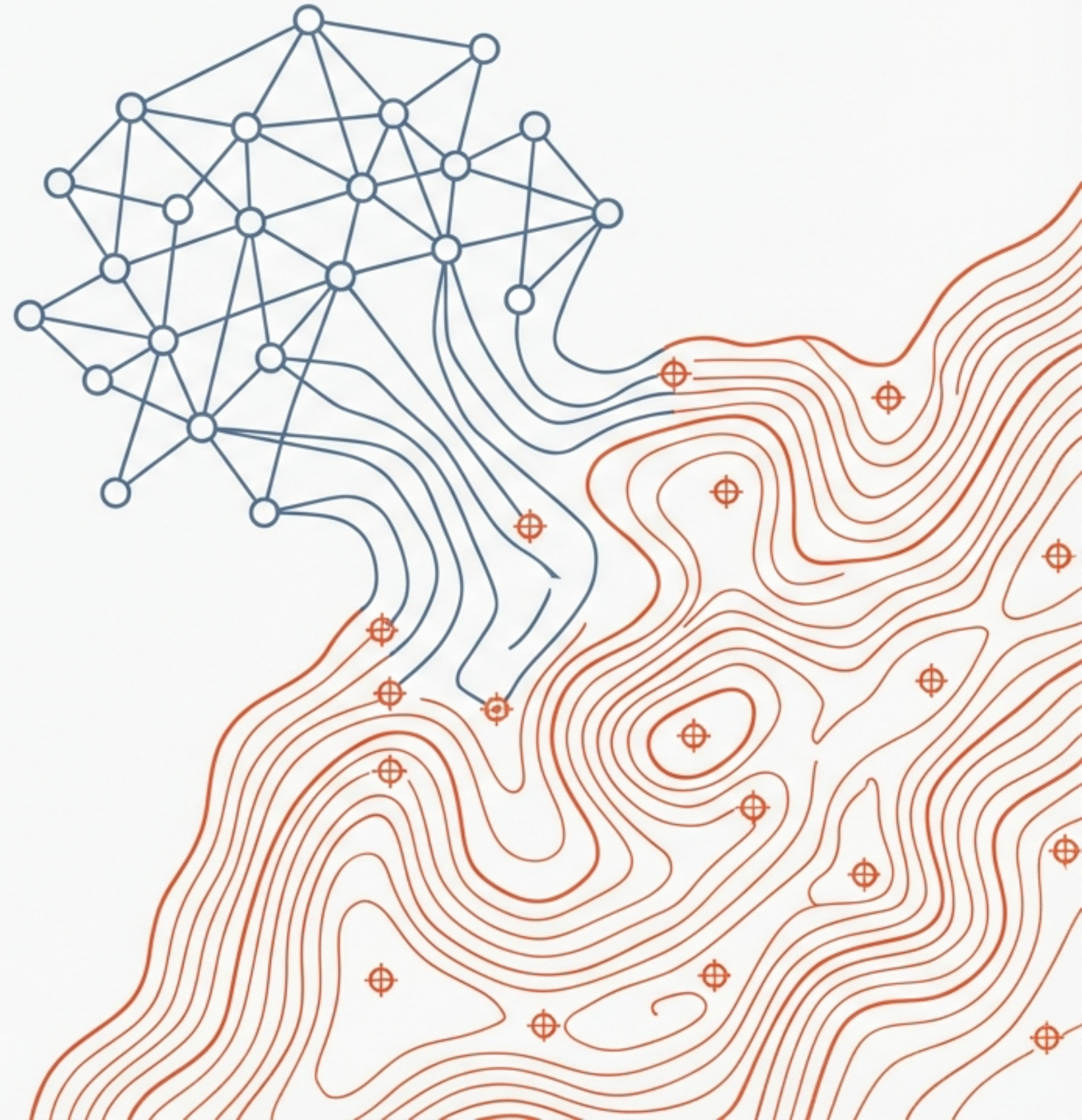


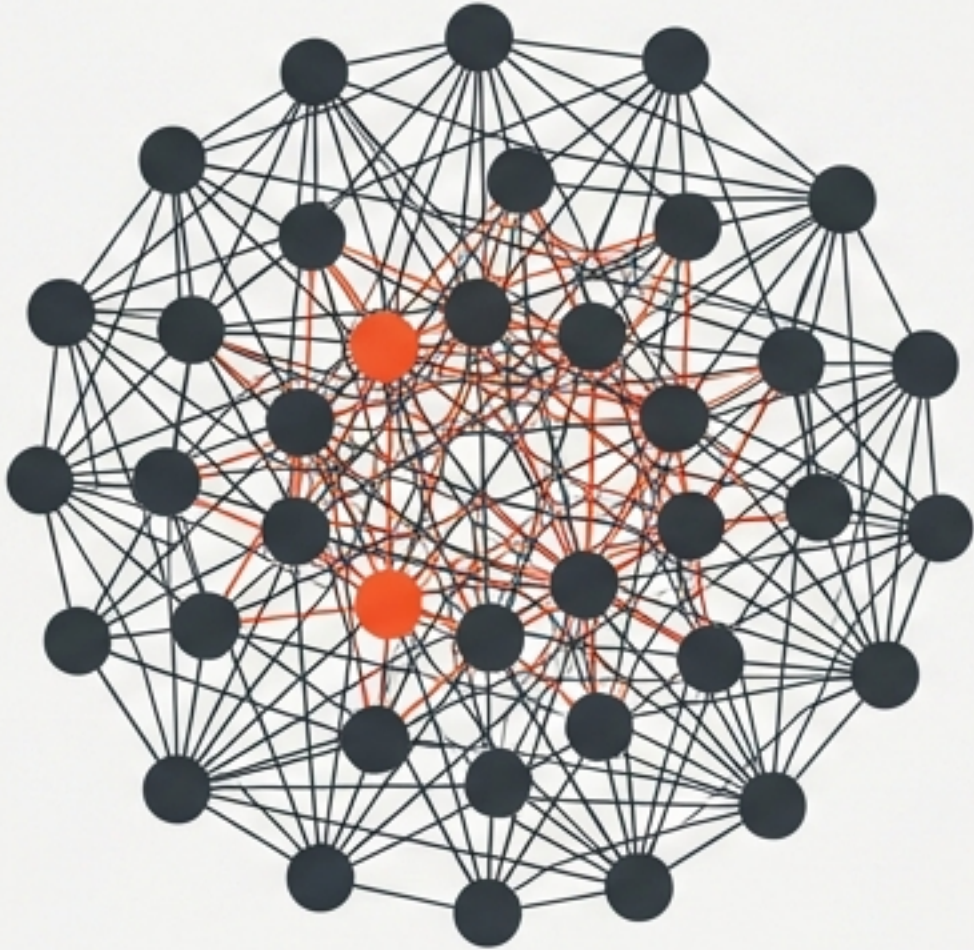
The Cartographer Role

Situational Awareness
Through Maps in the
Issues-FS Ecosystem.



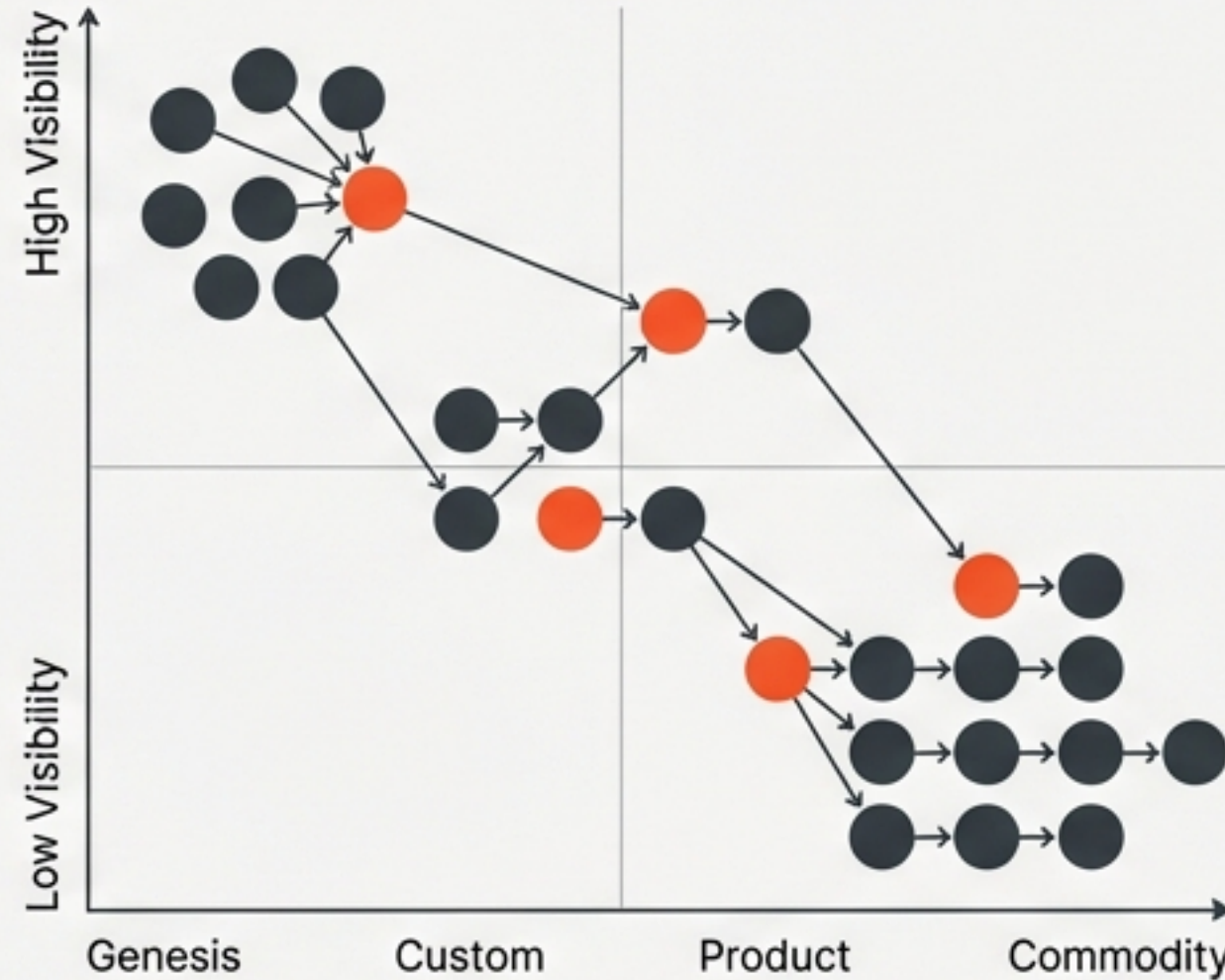
Connectivity is not Strategy

The Librarian (Meaning)



The Graph tells us what exists and how it relates.

The Cartographer (Strategy)



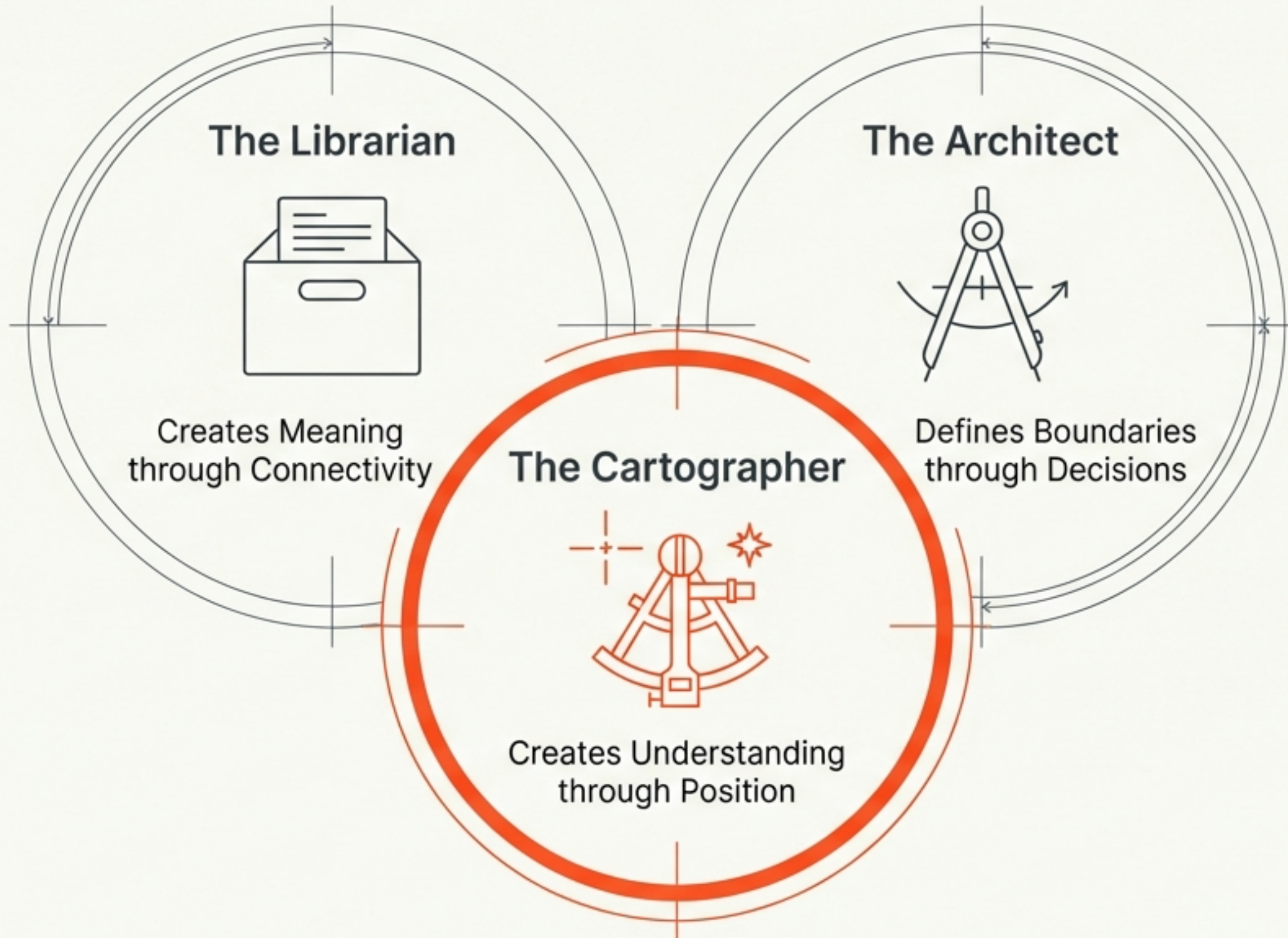
The Map tells us where things sit in value and maturity.

The ecosystem currently creates meaning through connectivity. However, a graph cannot answer strategic questions:

- What should we build next?
- What is becoming a commodity?
- Where are we under-investing in novelty?

*“Connectivity tells you what relates to what.
Position tells you what to do about it.”*

The Triad of Strategic Intent

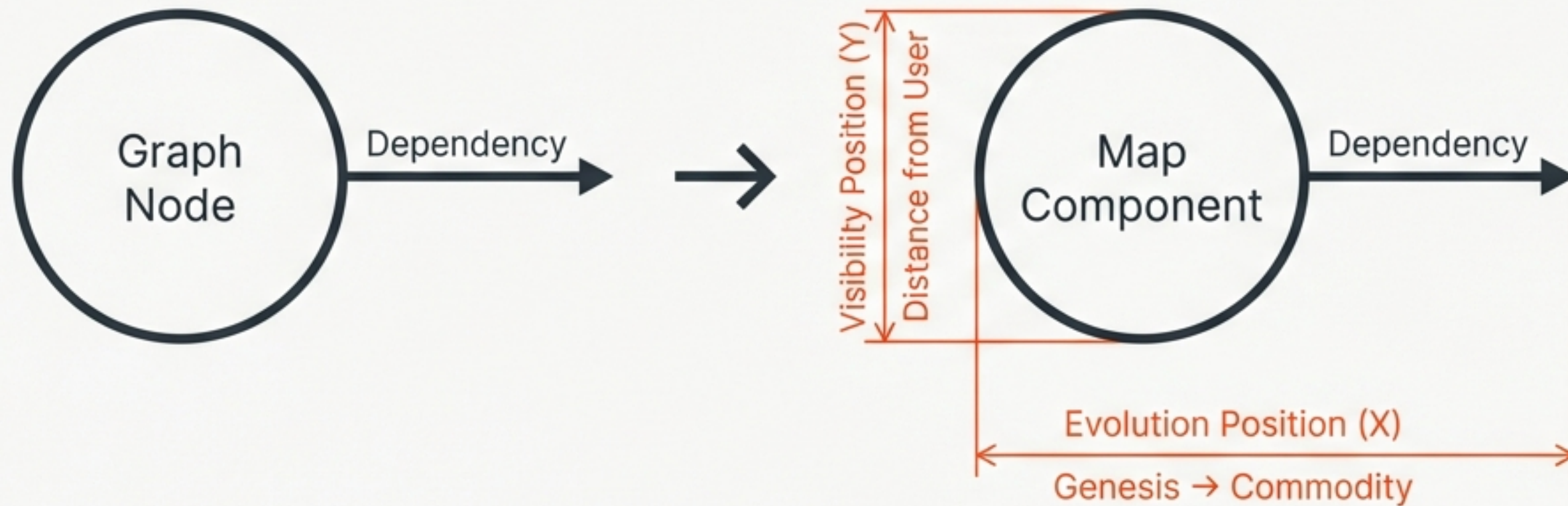


The Cartographer is not a visualisation role; it is a strategic intelligence role.

Core Output: Situational Awareness.

The ability to see where things are, where they are going, and what that implies for the ecosystem.

Maps are the Natural Evolution of Graphs



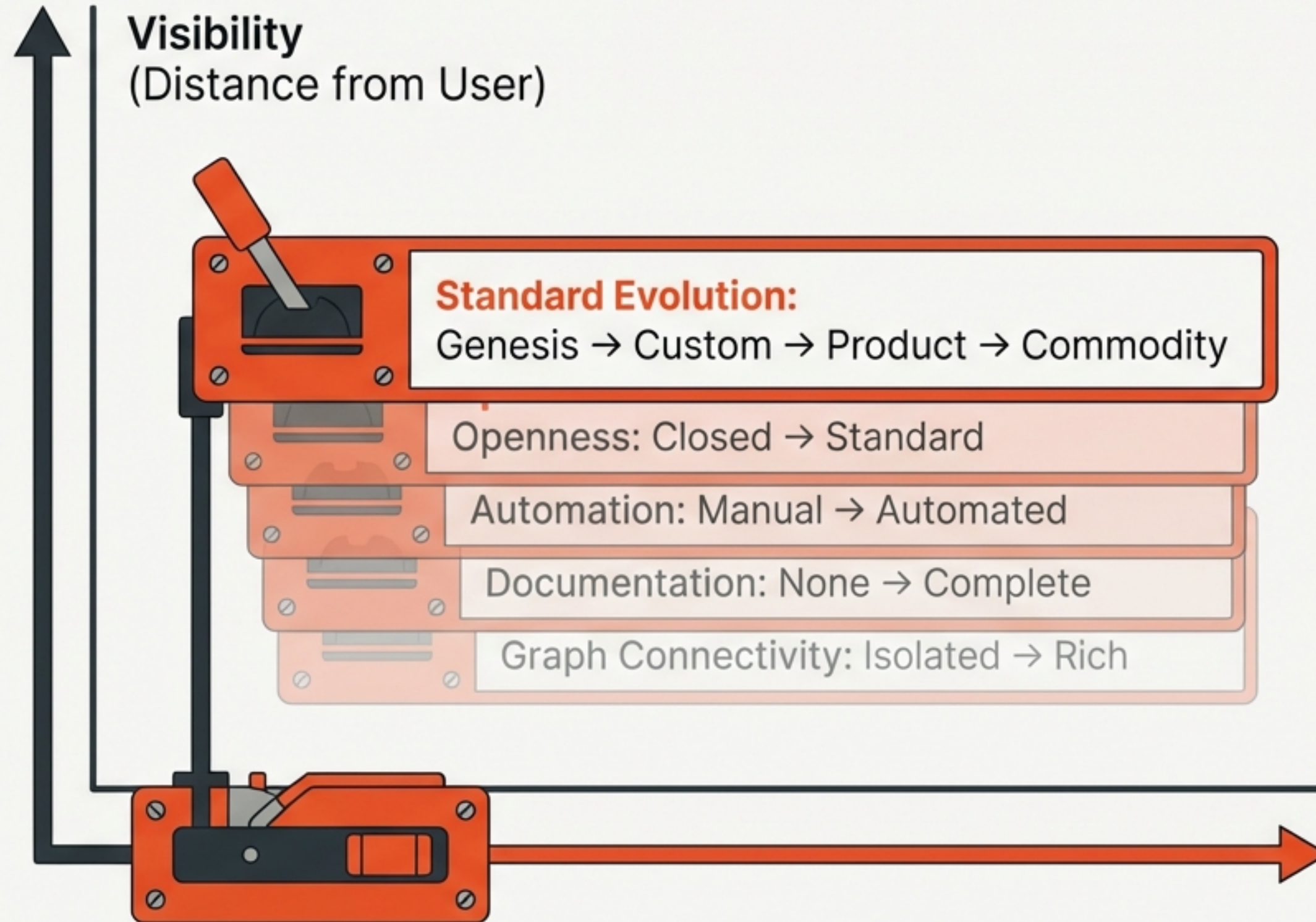
A Wardley Map is not a separate artifact. It is a graph projection requiring only two additional pieces of metadata per node.

Converting a subgraph to a map requires adding two edges per node.

Map data lives in the same graph infrastructure as everything else.

```
node.edges.push({ type: 'evolution_position', value: 0.2 })
node.edges.push({ type: 'visibility_position', value: 0.8 })
```

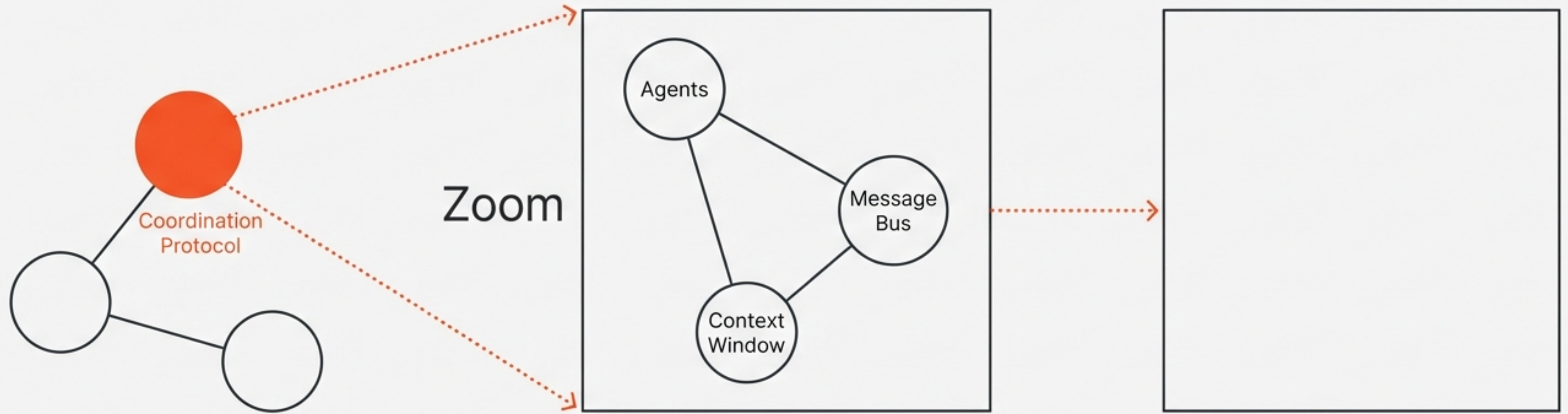

The Axes of Value and Evolution



While Visibility (Y) is constant, the Cartographer can project the same components against different **evolution dimensions (X)** to reveal hidden risks.

Maps of Maps of Maps

The Fractal Nature of Strategic Geometry



Maps compose exactly the way graphs compose. If a sub-map shows mostly Genesis components, the parent node on the higher-level map must also sit at Genesis.

Responsibility I: The Living Landscape

The Landscape Map

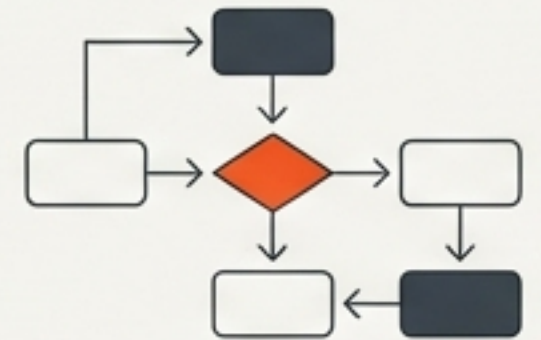
Root view. Tracing User Needs to Infrastructure.

 Updated Daily



Role Maturity Maps

One per role. Visualising workflows and tooling.



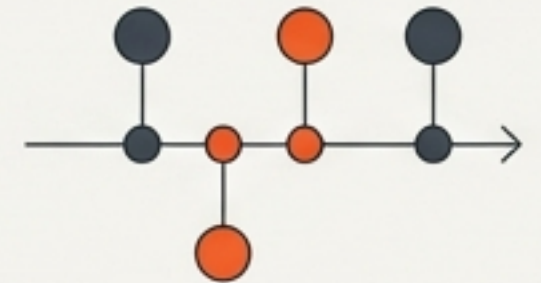
Competitive Comparison

Issues-FS vs. GitHub/Jira.
Differentiated by component position.



Per-Project Maps

Working maps for active epics.



Static maps are dangerous. The primary output is a set of maintained maps.
A map that was accurate three months ago is worse than no map.

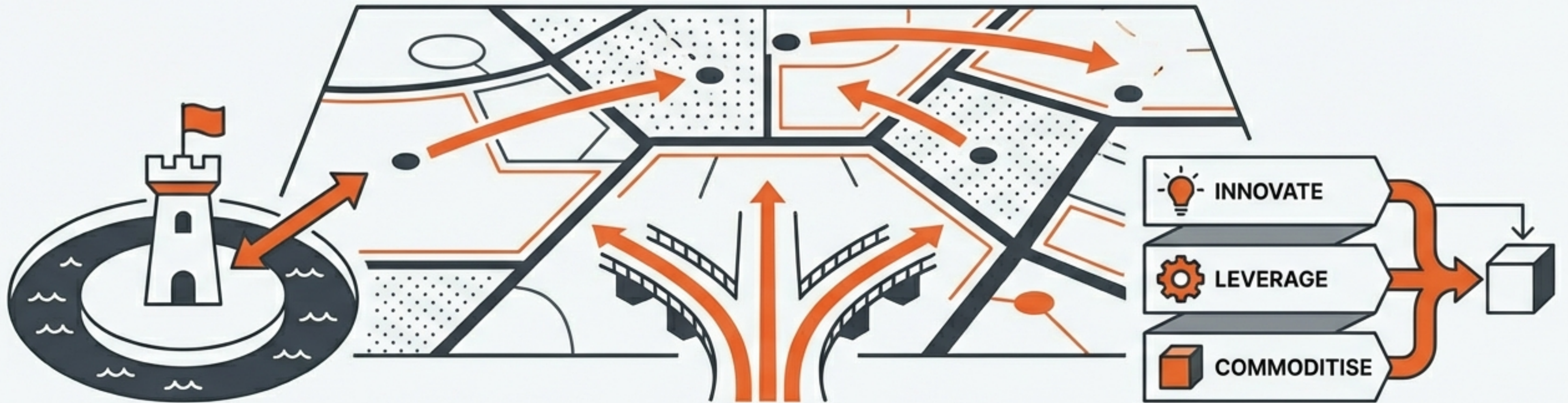
Responsibility II: Doctrine Assessment

Strategic Health Score	
1. Focus on user needs — [PASS]	
2. Move fast — [WARN]	
3. Use standards — [FAIL]	
4. Remove bias and duplication — [PASS]	
5. Optimise flow — [WARN]	

Beyond just drawing maps, the Cartographer scores the ecosystem against universal Wardley Doctrine. This creates a 'Health Score' for strategy. This assessment is fractal—applied to the ecosystem, a role, or a single sprint.

Responsibility II: Gameplay Identification

Advising the Architect and Conductor on specific plays. Identifying the moves on the board.



1. Tower and Moat

Defending graph-native tracking (Tower) with philosophy (Moat).

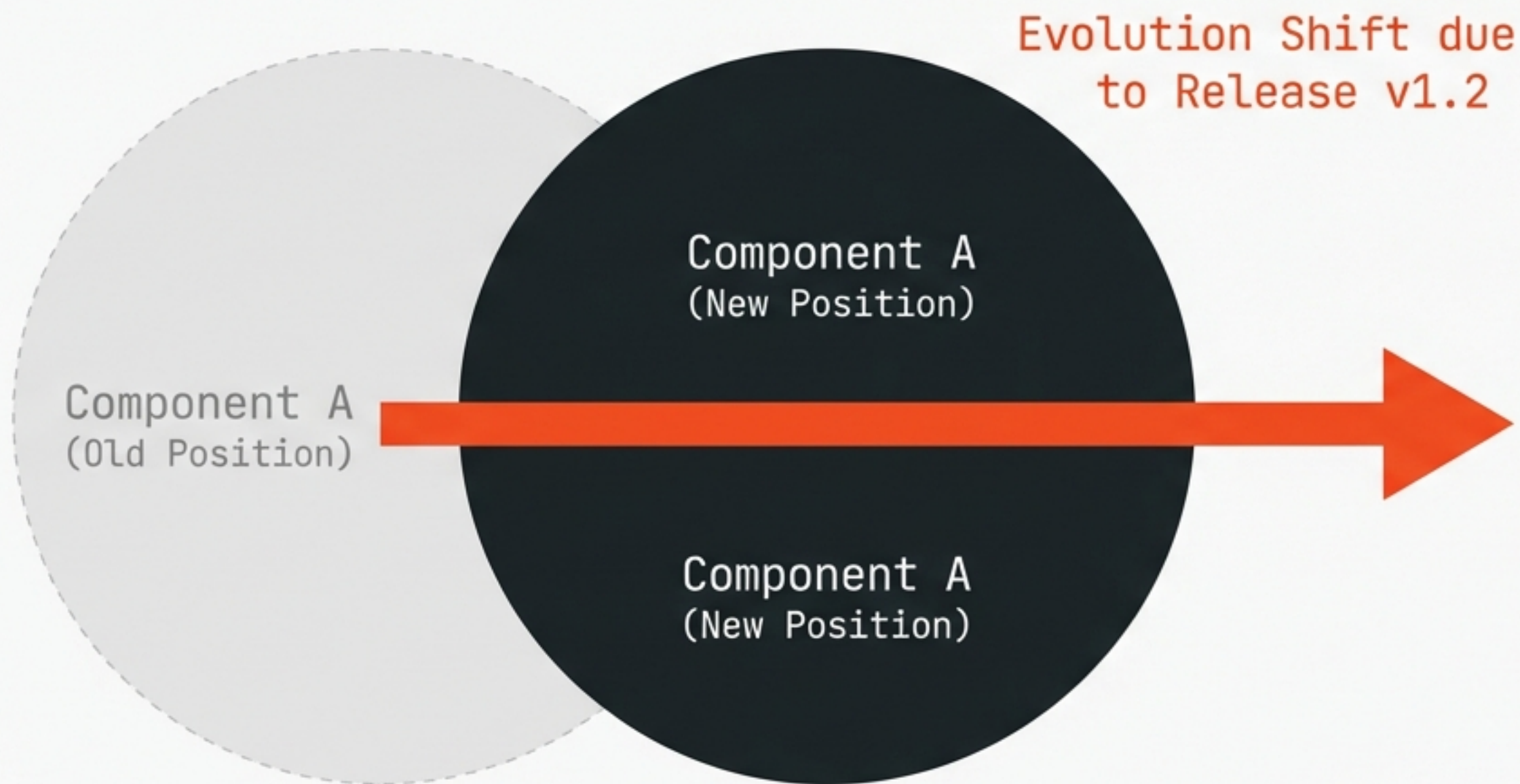
2. Open Approaches

Leveraging ecosystem to accelerate evolution.

3. ILC (Innovate-Leverage-Commoditise)

Can the Coordination Protocol become a commodity others depend on?

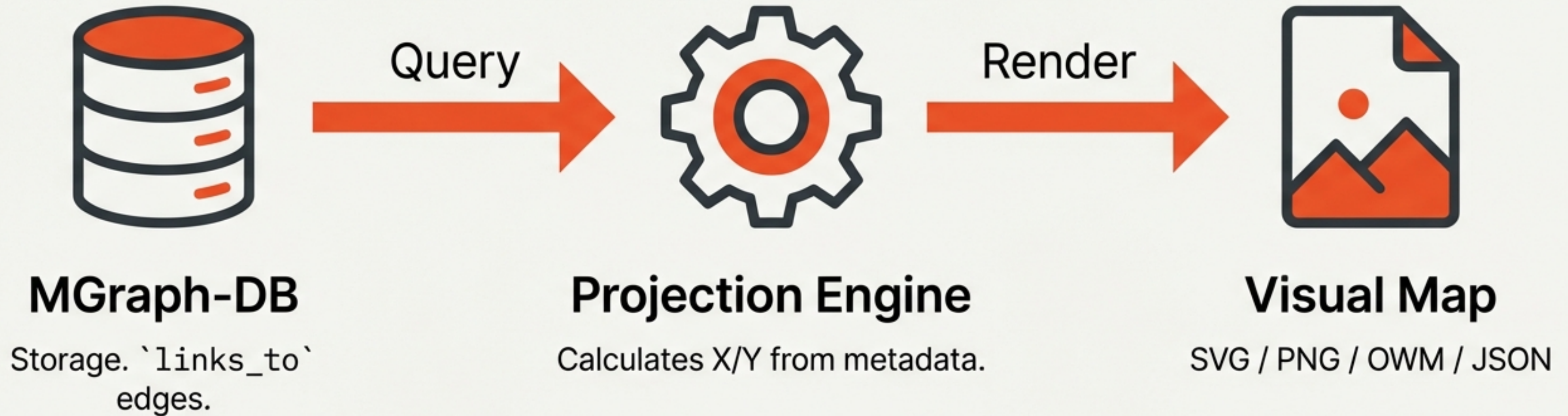
Responsibility IV: The Strategic Diff



Moving towards a future where every PR or release includes a 'Map Diff'—showing not just code changes, but landscape shifts.

- Did a component move from Custom-Built to Product?
- Did a new dependency appear?
- Did we accidentally reinvent a Commodity?

The Data Model



We do not use external silos. Map nodes link back to Ecosystem nodes via `'links_to'` edges. The Map is a projection of the Graph.

Collaboration: Leadership Roles

Vs. The Librarian

Complements, not competitors.

- Librarian organises knowledge; Cartographer positions it. – positions it.
- Librarian connectivity analysis feeds Cartographer evolution axes.



Vs. The Architect

Context vs. Decision.

- Cartographer provides context; Architect makes the decision.

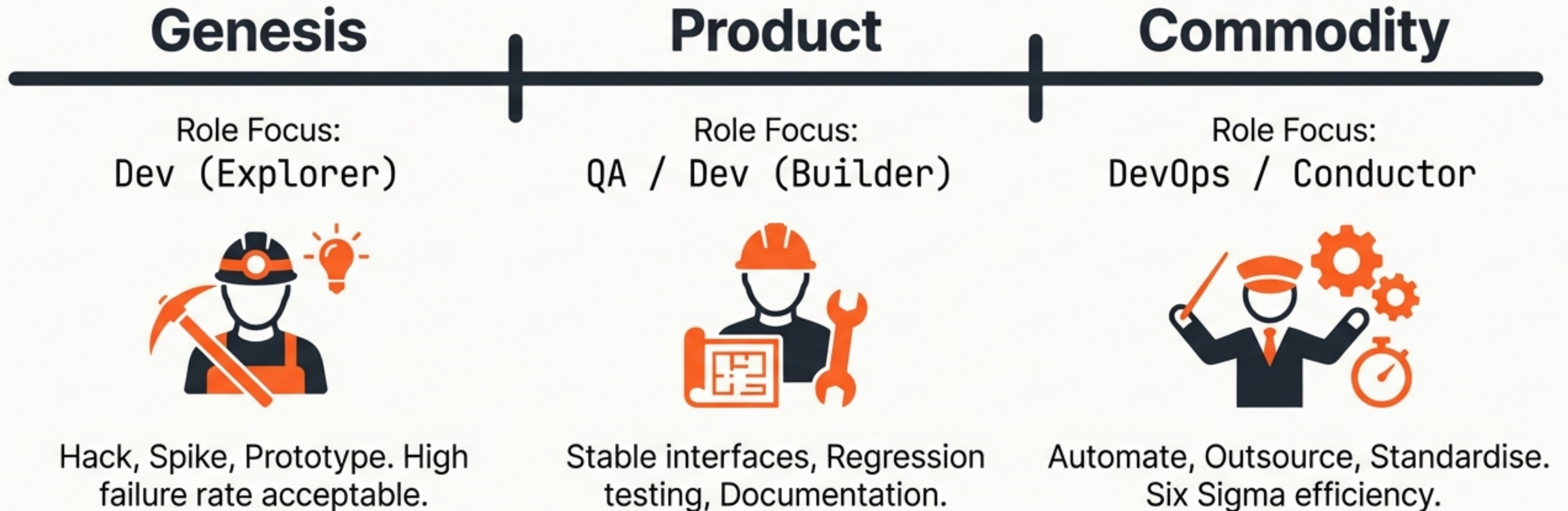
Example: "We chose WebSocket because it is a Product, not Genesis."



Every **Architectural Decision Record (ADR)** should reference a **map**.

Collaboration: Execution Roles

Engineering practices must match the evolution stage.

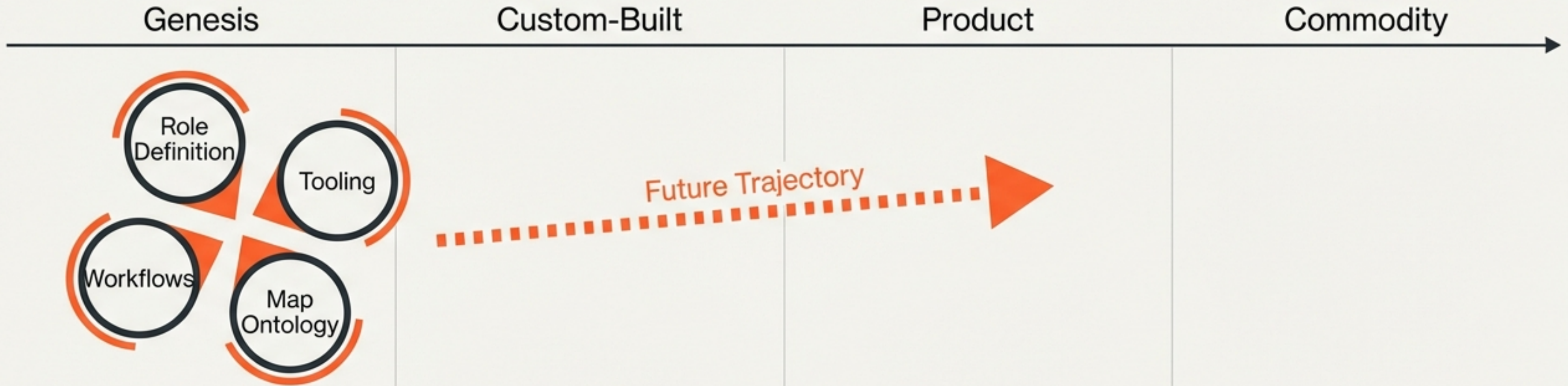


Conductor uses maps for prioritization. Developers and QA match their rigour to the component's position.

Bootstrapping the Role



The Cartographer's Own Map



Dogfooding the role. The Cartographer role is currently at Genesis. It is barely defined. As the role matures, its components will move right towards Product. The evolution of this map is the metric of success.

**Meaning comes from connectivity.
Understanding comes from position.**